

Run AI Locally

Three practical routes from download to fully local conversation

Everything up to this point has been preparation. You know what parameters and quantisation mean, you have shortlisted models, checked your hardware and learned how to navigate Hugging Face. Now comes the satisfying part: making a model answer you without sending the prompt to somebody else's AI service.

There is no single "correct" way to run a model locally. A graphical application prioritises simplicity, a command-line runtime can reduce the job to one command, and a lower-level engine exposes more performance controls.

We will use three routes. LM Studio is the easiest route for readers who want a desktop interface. Ollama is the comfortable middle ground for anyone willing to type commands.

